

```
❷ def setValue(self, newText):  
    if self.text == newText:  
        return # nothing to change  
  
    self.text = newText # save the new text  
    self.textSurface = self.font.render(self.text, True, self.textColor)  
  
❸ def draw(self):  
    self.window.blit(self.textSurface, self.loc)
```

Listing 6-6: The SimpleText class for displaying text

You can think of a `SimpleText` object as a field in the window where you want text to be displayed. You can use one to display unchanging label text or to display text that changes throughout a program.

The `SimpleText` class has only three methods. The `__init__()` method ❶ expects the window to draw into, the location at which to draw the text in the window, any initial text you want to see displayed in the field, and a text color. Calling `pygame.font.init()` ❷ starts up pygame's font system. The call in the first instantiated `SimpleText` object actually does the initialization; any additional `SimpleText` objects will also make this call, but since fonts have already been initialized, the call returns immediately. We create a new `Font` object with `pygame.font.SysFont()` ❸. Rather than providing a specific font name, `None` indicates that we will use whatever the standard system font is.

The `setValue()` method renders an image of the text to display and saves that image in the `self.textSurface` instance variable ❹. As the program runs, any time you want to change the text that's displayed, you call the `setValue()` method, passing in the new text to display. The `setValue()` method has an optimization, too: it remembers the last text that it rendered, and before doing anything else, it checks if the new text is the same as the previous text. If the text has not changed, there is nothing to do and the method just returns. If there is new text, it renders the new text into a surface to be drawn.

The `draw()` method ❺ draws the image contained in the `self.textSurface` instance variable into the window at the given location. This method should be called in every frame.